Xinya Du

Curriculum Vitae · October 2026

Contact

Assistant Professor (tenure-track)
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Research Impact

- **Citations.** 4,735 citations, h-index 29, i10-index 41 (Google Scholar, October 2026). "Learning to Ask" (ACL 2017) [51] has over 1,000 citations, is among Paper Digest's most influential ACL papers and the top 0.1% most-cited computer science articles of 2017, and was featured in *New Scientist* and *TechRepublic*; "Event Extraction by Answering (Almost) Natural Questions" (EMNLP 2020) [44] has over 600. Six papers from 2024–2025 already have over 150 citations each [1], [3], [5], [19], [21], [23].
- **Adoption beyond the lab.** OpenAI used DSBench [19] to evaluate ChatGPT agent (2025). PRD's peer evaluation of AI judges [5] has been built on by researchers at NYU, Anthropic, and Cohere; FaithScore [23] has been adopted by groups at Arizona State, the University of Washington, Johns Hopkins, and Intel Labs. Led the LLM usage-and-licensing section of *The Practical Guides for LLMs* on GitHub (10k+ stars).
- **Publications.** 66 papers and preprints: 5 journal articles (ACM Computing Surveys, IJCV, TMLR) and 46 peer-reviewed conference papers, 28 of them in the main proceedings of NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, EACL, and AAAI.
- **Recognition.** NSF CAREER Award (2024, funded on first submission); Best Paper Award, AAAI 2025 AI4Research Workshop; Best Poster Award (top 1%), ICML 2024 AI for Science Workshop; Outstanding Area Chair Award, EMNLP 2024; AAAI New Faculty Highlights (2024); Amazon (2023) and Cisco (2024) Research Awards; University of Chicago Rising Star in Data Science (2021).
- **Systems and resources.** First author of RESIN-11 [36]; led the integration of RESIN, the event-prediction system built under a $10M DARPA KAIROS grant and the top-ranked system in the program's evaluation. Built the PeerEval public leaderboard on PRD [5], and benchmarks including MEQA, DSBench, LMR-Bench, and SciEvent.
- **Community leadership.** Area Chair for ICML (2027), NeurIPS (2026), ICLR (2025, 2027), ACL, EMNLP, and COLING; NSF review panels, including CAREER (2025, 2026); co-organizer of tutorials at AAAI 2026 and ICMR 2025 and of workshops at AAAI 2025, CVPR 2025, and IJCAI 2025; over 20 invited talks and panels.
- **Funding.** $1.02M in external research funding as sole PI (NSF CAREER, Open Philanthropy, Amazon, Cisco, Adobe, OpenAI), plus Amazon awards as co-PI and lead contributor.
- **Mentoring and teaching.** Three Ph.D. students (two finishing in 2026) and over 20 master's, undergraduate, and K–12 students; former mentees went on to Ph.D. programs at CMU, Cornell, and NTU. An undergraduate mentee published in TMLR and won a Jonsson School award, and K–12 outreach projects led to the paper underlying the NSF CAREER award. New LLM course rated 4.75/5 (instructor) and 4.65/5 (course); President's Teaching Excellence Award nominee.
- **Most related to this proposal** ($\star$ in the publication list). AI judges that evaluate one another (PRD [5], IQA-EVAL [24]); step-level rewards and verification (FG-PRM [15], HiPRAG [10], training-free verification [12]); evaluation benchmarks (MEQA [22], FaithScore [23], LMR-Bench [14]); red-teaming of code models (COMET [57]); and AI for science (LDC [6], LLM4SR [1]).

Research Interests

Natural language processing and large language models: reasoning, post-training, and alignment; trustworthy evaluation and oversight of AI agents (peer evaluation, debate, process reward models); information extraction; AI for science.

Education

Cornell University Aug 2016 – Aug 2021
Ph.D. in Computer Science (M.S. degree granted in Aug 2019)
Dissertation: *Towards More Intelligent Extraction of Information from Documents*
Advisor: Claire Cardie. Worked closely with Sasha Rush.

Shanghai Jiao Tong University Sep 2012 – Aug 2016
B.E. in Computer Science and Engineering
Outstanding Graduates Award

Professional Experience

The University of Texas at Dallas Aug 2022 – Present
Assistant Professor (tenure-track), Department of Computer Science

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign Sep 2021 – Aug 2022
Postdoctoral Research Associate. Worked with Heng Ji.

Industrial Experience

Google AI Research May 2020 – Aug 2020
Research Intern. Supervisor: Luheng He, Qi Li, Emily Pitler.

Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence (AI2) Sep 2018 – Dec 2018
Research Intern. Supervisor: Bhavana Dalvi, Peter Clark.

Microsoft Research (MSR) May 2018 – Aug 2018
Research Intern. Supervisor: Paul Bennett, Ahmed Awadallah.

Awards & Honors

Best Paper Award (for LDC [6]) AAAI AI4Research Workshop, 2025
Faculty Research Award Department of Computer Science, UT Dallas, 2025
NSF CAREER Award National Science Foundation, 2024
Outstanding Area Chair Award EMNLP, 2024
Best Poster Award (top 1% of 250 submissions; [21]) ICML AI for Science Workshop, 2024
AAAI New Faculty Highlights (paper [27]) AAAI, 2024
Cisco Faculty Research Award Cisco, 2024
President's Teaching Excellence Award Nominee UT Dallas, 2024
Amazon Research Award Amazon, 2023
Spotlight Rising Star in Data Science University of Chicago, 2021
Top 100 New Stars in Artificial Intelligence Baidu Scholar, 2020
Most Influential ACL Papers (15 each year; [51]) Paper Digest, 2017
Outstanding Graduates Award Shanghai Jiao Tong University, 2016
National Scholarship (top 1% of students nationwide) SJTU, 2013
National Olympiad in Mathematics in Provinces, First Prize 2011
National Olympiad in Informatics in Provinces, First Prize 2010

Paper-level recognition (oral presentations, top-1% and top-0.1% most-cited designations, media coverage, and the DARPA KAIROS result) is noted with each publication below.

Grants

Control Evaluations for AI Debate (Single PI)
Funding Source: Open Philanthropy.
Period: Oct 2025 – present.
Amount Awarded: $218,513 (+ $40,000 computing). Amount to me: $218,513.

NSF CAREER: Learning to Extract Consistent Event Graphs from Long and Complex Documents (Single PI)
Funding Source: National Science Foundation (NSF).
Period: May 2024 – present.
Amount Awarded: $561,219. Amount to me: $561,219.
Awarded on first submission.

Adobe Research Gift: Hallucinations in Video Language Models (Single PI)
Funding Source: Adobe.
Period: Sep 2025 – present.
Amount Awarded: $30,000.

Process-guided Fine-tuning for Answering Complex Questions (Single PI)
Funding Source: Amazon Research Award.
Period: Jan 2024 – present.
Amount Awarded: $110,000 ($40,000 AWS credits). Amount to me: $110,000.

Amazon Trusted AI Challenge Grant (Co-PI, with Prof. Wei Yang)
Funding Source: Amazon.
Period: Jan 2025 – present.
Amount Awarded to Our Team: $250,000.

Optimizing RISC-V Compilers with RISC-LLM and Syntax Parsing (Lead Contributor; PI: Wei Yang)
Funding Source: Amazon Research Award.
Period: Sep 2025 – Aug 2026.
Amount Awarded: $70,000. Amount to me: $23,000.

FAIGen: Faithful LLM Generation with Scientific Principles-guided Learning (Single PI)
Funding Source: Cisco Faculty Research Award.
Period: Jan 2025 – present.
Amount Awarded: $90,000. Amount to me: $90,000.

Mitigating Hallucinations in Vision-language Models with Fine-grained AI Feedback (Single PI)
Funding Source: OpenAI Researcher Access Program.
Period: Sep 2024 – present.
Amount Awarded: $12,000. Amount to me: $12,000.

Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Award (URAP) (Single PI)
Funding Source: University of Texas at Dallas.
Period: Summer 2023, 2024, 2025.
Amount Awarded: $13,500. Amount to me: $13,500.

New Faculty Research Symposium Grant (Leading PI)
Funding Source: University of Texas at Dallas.
Period: Aug 2025 – Jul 2026.
Amount Awarded: $25,000.

Grants (Pending)

Collaborative Research: RI: SMALL: Explainable Methods for Natural Language Reasoning (Leading PI, co-PI: Prof. Claire Cardie)
Funding Source: National Science Foundation (NSF).
Period: Jan 2025 – Dec 2028.
Amount Requested: $600,000. Amount to me: $300,000.
Status: Pending (**rated highly competitive on first submission**).

ACED: Large Language Model-based Research Agent for Synthetic Biology Research Idea Generation (Leading PI, co-PI: Prof. Leo Bleris)
Funding Source: National Science Foundation (NSF).
Period: Aug 2026 – Dec 2028.
Amount Requested: $600,000. Amount to me: $300,000.
Status: Pending (**rated competitive on first submission**).

III: Automating Scientific Knowledge Discovery through Retrieval, Generation, and Validation (Leading PI, co-PI: Prof. Vincent Ng)
Funding Source: National Science Foundation (NSF).
Period: Jan 2027 – Dec 2029.
Amount Requested: $600,000. Amount to me: $300,000.
Status: Pending.

LLM-Guided Agents for Rational and Reliable Cell Reprogramming (Co-PI, co-PI: Prof. Leo Bleris)
Funding Source: National Science Foundation (NSF) Directorate for Biological Sciences (BIO).
Period: Aug 2026 – Dec 2029.
Amount Requested: $726,459. Amount to me: $242,153.
Status: Pending.

Publications

Notes: † co-leading author; * equal contribution; ⋆ work most related to the proposed ONR research. Current lists are also on [DBLP] and [Google Scholar]. In computer science, peer-reviewed conference proceedings are the primary archival venue for research; the main tracks of NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, EACL, and AAAI are highly selective, most accepting roughly 20–30% of submissions.

Journal Articles

[1] ⋆**LLM4SR: A Survey on Large Language Models for Scientific Research** [pdf]
Ziming Luo, Zonglin Yang, Zexin Xu, Wei Yang, **Xinya Du**
In ACM Computing Surveys (CSUR), to appear.

[2] **Dr.V: A Hierarchical Perception-Temporal-Cognition Framework to Diagnose Video Hallucination by Fine-Grained Spatial-Temporal Grounding** [pdf]
Meng Luo, Shengqiong Wu, Liqiang Jing, Tianjie Ju, Li Zheng, Jinxiang Lai, Tianlong Wu, **Xinya Du**, Jian Li, Siyuan Yan, Jiebo Luo, William Yang Wang, Hao Fei, Mong-Li Lee, Wynne Hsu
In International Journal of Computer Vision (IJCV), 2026.

[3] **SFT or RL? An Early Investigation into Training R1-Like Reasoning Large Vision-Language Models** [pdf]
Hardy Chen, Haoqin Tu, Fali Wang, Hui Liu, Xianfeng Tang, **Xinya Du**, Yuyin Zhou, Cihang Xie
In Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2025.

[4] **FGAIF: Aligning Large Vision-Language Models with Fine-grained AI Feedback** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, **Xinya Du**
In Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2025.

[5] ⋆**PRD: Peer Rank and Discussion Improve Large Language Model-based Evaluations** [pdf]
Ruosen Li, Teerth Patel, **Xinya Du**
In Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2024.
Public leaderboard built on this work: peereval-ai.github.io

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers (main, Findings, and demonstration tracks)

[6] ⋆**LDC: Learning to Generate Research Idea with Dynamic Control** [pdf]
Ruochen Li, Liqiang Jing, Chi Han, Jiawei Zhou, **Xinya Du**
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2026.
Earlier version in AAAI 2025 AI4Research Workshop. **(Oral)**
Best Paper Award, AAAI 2025 AI4Research Workshop.

[7] **A Comprehensive Analysis for Visual Object Hallucination in Large Vision-Language Models** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, Hardy Chen, Ehsan Aghazadeh, Xin Eric Wang, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2026.

[8] **A Skill-augmented Agentic Framework and Benchmark for Multi-Video Understanding** [pdf]
Yue Zhang, Liqiang Jing, Jia Li, Yapeng Tian, **Xinya Du**, Yunhui Guo, Vibhav Giridhar Gogate
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2026.

[9] **AMARIS: A Memory-Augmented Rubric Improvement System for Rubric-Based Reinforcement Learning** [pdf]
Peilin Wu, Xinlu Zhang, Kun Wan, Wentian Zhao, Gang Wu, **Xinya Du**, Zhiyu Chen
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2026.

[10] ⋆**HiPRAG: Hierarchical Process Rewards for Efficient Agentic Retrieval Augmented Generation** [pdf]
Peilin Wu, Mian Zhang, Kun Wan, Wentian Zhao, Kaiyu He, **Xinya Du**, Zhiyu Chen
In International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026.

[11] **Is Grokking Worthwhile? Functional Analysis and Transferability of Generalization Circuits in Transformers** [pdf]
Kaiyu He, Mian Zhang, Peilin Wu, **Xinya Du**, Zhiyu Chen
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL, 2026.

[12] ⋆**Your Reasoning Model is Secretly a Reward Model – Optimization-Free Verification from Experience** [pdf]
Zhenwen Liang, Ruosen Li, Yujun Zhou, Linfeng Song, Dian Yu, **Xinya Du**, Haitao Mi, Dong Yu
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2026.

[13] **FIFA: Unified Faithfulness Evaluation Framework for Text-to-Video and Video-to-Text Generation** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, Viet Dac Lai, Seunghyun Yoon, Trung Bui, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL, 2026.

[14] ⋆**LMR-Bench: Evaluating LLM Agent's Ability on Reproducing Language Modeling Research** [pdf]
Shuo Yan, Ziming Luo, Zimu Wang, Ruochen Li, Daoyang Li, Liqiang Jing, Kaiyu He, Peilin Wu, Juntong Ni, George Michalopoulos, Yue Zhang, Ziyang Zhang, Mian Zhang, Zhiyu Chen, **Xinya Du**
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2025.

[15] ⋆**FG-PRM: Fine-grained Hallucination Detection and Mitigation in Language Model Mathematical Reasoning** [pdf]
Ruosen Li, Ziming Luo, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2025.

[16] **SciEvent: Benchmarking Multi-domain Scientific Event Extraction** [pdf]
Bofu Dong, Pritesh Shah, Sumedh Sonawane, Tiyasha Banerjee, Erin Brady, **Xinya Du**, Ming Jiang
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2025.

[17] **Search Wisely: Mitigating Sub-optimal Agentic Searches By Reducing Uncertainty** [pdf]
Peilin Wu, Mian Zhang, Xinlu Zhang, **Xinya Du**, Zhiyu Chen
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2025.

[18] **VistaDPO: Video Hierarchical Spatial-Temporal Direct Preference Optimization for Large Video Models** [pdf]
Haojian Huang*, Haodong Chen*, Shengqiong Wu, Meng Luo, Jinlan Fu, **Xinya Du**, Hanwang Zhang, Hao Fei
In International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2025.

[19] **DSBench: How Far Are Data Science Agents from Becoming Data Science Experts?** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, Zhehui Huang, Xiaoyang Wang, Wenlin Yao, Wenhao Yu, Kaixin Ma, Hongming Zhang, **Xinya Du**, Dong Yu
In International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2025.
Used by OpenAI to evaluate ChatGPT agent. [Link]

[20] **FIHA: Autonomous Hallucination Evaluation in Vision-Language Models with Davidson Scene Graphs** [pdf]
Bowen Yan, Zhengsong Zhang, Liqiang Jing, Eftekhar Hossain and **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL, 2025.

[21] **Large Language Models for Automated Open-domain Scientific Hypotheses Discovery** [pdf]
Zonglin Yang, **Xinya Du**†, Junxian Li, Jie Zheng, Soujanya Poria, Erik Cambria
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL, 2024.
Best poster award in ICML AI4Science, 2024 (Top 1% of 250 submissions).

[22] ⋆**Multi-hop Event-centric Question Answering with Explanations**
Ruosen Li, Zimu Wang, Son Quoc Tran, Lei Xia, **Xinya Du**
In Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2024.

[23] ⋆**FaithScore: Fine-grained Evaluations of Hallucinations in Large Vision-Language Models** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, Ruosen Li, Yunmo Chen, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2024.

[24] ⋆**IQA-EVAL: Automatic Evaluation of Human-Model Interactive Question Answering** [pdf]
Ruosen Li, Ruochen Li, Barry Wang, **Xinya Du**
In Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2024.

[25] **QAEvent: Event Extraction as Question-Answer Pairs Generation** [pdf]
Milind Choudhary, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL, 2024.

[26] **Language Models as Inductive Reasoners** [pdf]
Zonglin Yang, Li Dong, **Xinya Du**†, Hao Cheng, Erik Cambria, Xiaodong Liu, Jianfeng Gao, Furu Wei
In Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL), 2024. **(Oral)**

[27] **Making Natural Language Reasoning Explainable and Faithful** [pdf]
Xinya Du
In AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2024. New Faculty Highlights. **(Oral)**

[28] **Proto-CLIP: Vision-Language Prototypical Network for Few-Shot Learning** [pdf]
Jishnu Jaykumar P, Kamalesh Palanisamy, Yu-Wei Chao, **Xinya Du**, Yu Xiang
In International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2024. **(Oral)**

[29] **Document-level Causal Relation Extraction with Knowledge-guided Binary Question Answering** [pdf]
Zimu Wang, Lei Xia, Wei Wang, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2024.

[30] **Leveraging Structured Information for Explainable Multi-hop Question Answering and Reasoning** [pdf]
Ruosen Li, **Xinya Du**
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2023.

[31] **Process of Elimination for Multiple Choice Reasoning** [pdf]
Chenkai Ma, **Xinya Du**
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2023.

[32] **Probing Representations for Document-level Event Extraction** [pdf]
Barry Wang, **Xinya Du**, Claire Cardie
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2023.

[33] **End-to-end Case-Based Reasoning for Commonsense Knowledge Base Completion** [pdf]
Zonglin Yang, **Xinya Du**†, Erik Cambria, Claire Cardie
In Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL), 2023. **(Oral)**

[34] **Zero-Shot Classification by Logical Reasoning on Natural Language Explanations** [pdf]
Chi Han, Hengzhi Pei, **Xinya Du**, Heng Ji
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL, 2023.

[35] **Logical Entity Representation in Knowledge-Graphs for Differentiable Rule Learning** [pdf]
Chi Han, Qizheng He, Charles Yu, **Xinya Du**, Hanghang Tong, Heng Ji
In International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2023.

[36] **RESIN-11: Schema-guided Event Prediction for 11 Newsworthy Scenarios** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Zixuan Zhang, Sha Li, Heng Ji, the RESIN team
In Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL): System Demonstrations, 2022.
Top ranking system in DARPA KAIROS evaluation. [Link]

[37] **Retrieval-Augmented Generative Question Answering for Event Argument Extraction** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Heng Ji
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2022.

[38] **Dynamic Global Memory for Document-level Argument Extraction** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Sha Li, Heng Ji
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2022.

[39] **Automatic Error Analysis for Document-level Information Extraction** [pdf]
Aliva Das*, **Xinya Du***, Barry Wang*, Kejian Shi, Jiayuan Gu, Thomas Porter, Claire Cardie
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2022.

[40] **Template Filling with Generative Transformers** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Alexander M. Rush, Claire Cardie
In Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), 2021.

[41] **GRIT: Generative Role-filler Transformers for Document-level Event Entity Extraction** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Alexander M. Rush, Claire Cardie
In Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL), 2021. **(Oral)**

[42] **Few-shot Intent Classification and Slot Filling with Retrieved Examples** [pdf]
Dian Yu, Luheng He, Yuan Zhang, **Xinya Du**, Panupong Pasupat, Qi Li
In Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), 2021. **(Oral)**

[43] **QA-Driven Zero-shot Slot Filling with Weak Supervision Pretraining** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Luheng He, Qi Li, Dian Yu, Panupong Pasupat, Yuan Zhang
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2021.

[44] **Event Extraction by Answering (Almost) Natural Questions** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Claire Cardie
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2020. **(Oral)**
Top 1% most cited articles published in Computer Science in 2020.

[45] **Improving Event Duration Prediction via Time-aware Pre-training** [pdf]
Zonglin Yang, **Xinya Du**, Alexander M. Rush, Claire Cardie
In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, 2020.

[46] **Document-Level Event Role Filler Extraction using Multi-Granularity Contextualized Encoding** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Claire Cardie
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2020.

[47] **Leveraging Structured Metadata for Improving Question Answering on the Web** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Adam Fourney, Robert Sim, Claire Cardie, Paul Bennett, Ahmed Hassan Awadallah
In Conference of the Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (AACL/IJCNLP), 2020.

[48] **Be Consistent! Improving Procedural Text Comprehension using Label Consistency** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Bhavana Dalvi, Niket Tandon, Antoine Bosselut, Wen-tau Yih, Peter Clark, Claire Cardie
In Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), 2019.

[49] **Harvesting Paragraph-Level Question-Answer Pairs from Wikipedia** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Claire Cardie
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2018. **(Oral)**
Top 1% most cited articles published in Computer Science in 2018.

[50] **Identifying Where to Focus in Reading Comprehension for Neural Question Generation** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Claire Cardie
In Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2017.

[51] **Learning to Ask: Neural Question Generation for Reading Comprehension** [pdf]
Xinya Du, Junru Shao, Claire Cardie
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2017.
Most Influential ACL Papers (15 each year). [Link]
Featured in New Scientist and TechRepublic. [Link]
Top 0.1% most cited articles published in Computer Science in 2017.

Workshop Papers, Tutorial Abstracts, and Shared-Task Reports

[52] **Efficient Document-level Event Relation Extraction**
Ruochen Li, Zimu Wang, **Xinya Du**
In 10th Workshop on Representation Learning for NLP at Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), 2025.

[53] **Hallucinations in Large Language Models and Large Vision-Language Models (Tutorial)** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, Yue Zhang, **Xinya Du**
In Proceedings of the ACM International Conference on Multimedia Retrieval (ICMR), pp. 2138–2139, 2025.

[54] **Logical Reasoning over Natural Language as Knowledge Representation: A Survey** [pdf]
Zonglin Yang, **Xinya Du**, Rui Mao, Jinjie Ni, Erik Cambria
In Workshop on Natural Language Reasoning and Structured Explanations (NLRSE) at Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2023.

[55] **Toward Consistent and Informative Event-Event Temporal Relation Extraction** [pdf]
Xiaomeng Jin, Haoyang Wen, **Xinya Du**, Heng Ji
In MATCHING at Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2023. **(Oral)**

[56] **Cornell Belief and Sentiment System at TAC 2016** [pdf]
Vlad Niculae, Kai Sun, Xilun Chen, Yao Cheng, **Xinya Du**, Esin Durmus, Arzoo Katiyar, Claire Cardie
In Text Analysis Conference (TAC), 2016.

Challenge Proceedings

[57] ⋆**COMET: Closed-loop Orchestration for Malicious Elicitation Techniques in Code Models** [pdf]
Z. Xu, T. Li, R. S. Rathnasuriya, Z. Song, J. Ren, B. Mandalapu, S. Setayeshpour, **Xinya Du**, Wei Yang
In 1st Proceedings of Amazon Nova AI Challenge (Trusted AI), 2025.

Preprints

[58] **Be Consistent! Enhancing Robust Visual Reasoning in LVLMs with Consistency Constraints** [pdf]
Liqiang Jing, Xiong Zhou, Siddharth Varia, Neha Anna John, **Xinya Du**, Vassilis N. Ioannidis
arXiv:2607.21722, 2026.

[59] **Event Extraction in Large Language Model** [pdf]
Bobo Li, Xudong Han, Jiang Liu, Yuzhe Ding, Liqiang Jing, Zhaoqi Zhang, Jinheng Li, **Xinya Du**, Fei Li, Meishan Zhang, Min Zhang, Aixin Sun, Philip S. Yu, Hao Fei
arXiv:2512.19537, 2025.

[60] **GEAR: A General Evaluation Framework for Abductive Reasoning** [pdf]
Kaiyu He, Peilin Wu, Mian Zhang, Kun Wan, Wentian Zhao, **Xinya Du**, Zhiyu Chen
arXiv:2509.24096, 2025.

[61] **AALC: Large Language Model Efficient Reasoning via Adaptive Accuracy-Length Control** [pdf]
Ruosen Li, Ziming Luo, Quan Zhang, Ruochen Li, Ben Zhou, Ali Payani, **Xinya Du**
arXiv:2506.20160, 2025.

[62] **Multimodal Reference Visual Grounding** [pdf]
Yangxiao Lu, Ruosen Li, Liqiang Jing, Jikai Wang, **Xinya Du**, Yunhui Guo, Nicholas Ruozzi, Yu Xiang
arXiv:2504.02876, 2025.

[63] **Do Retrieval-Augmented Language Models Adapt to Varying User Needs?** [pdf]
Peilin Wu, Xinlu Zhang, Wenhao Yu, Xingyu Liu, **Xinya Du**, Zhiyu Zoey Chen
arXiv:2502.19779, 2025.

[64] **MLR-Copilot: Autonomous Machine Learning Research based on Large Language Models Agents** [pdf]
Ruochen Li, Teerth Patel, Qingyun Wang, **Xinya Du**
arXiv:2408.14033, 2024.
The first autonomous LLM agent for the entire machine learning research process: generating hypotheses, implementing ideas, and running experiments.

[65] **VIA: Unified Spatiotemporal Video Adaptation Framework for Global and Local Video Editing** [pdf]
Jing Gu, Yuwei Fang, Ivan Skorokhodov, Peter Wonka, **Xinya Du**, Sergey Tulyakov, Xin Eric Wang
arXiv:2406.12831, 2024.

[66] **AGent: A Novel Pipeline for Automatically Creating Unanswerable Questions** [pdf]
Son Quoc Tran, Gia-Huy Do, Phong Nguyen-Thuan Do, Matt Kretchmar, **Xinya Du**
arXiv:2309.05103, 2023.

Dissertation

[67] **Towards More Intelligent Extraction of Information from Documents**
Xinya Du
Ph.D. Dissertation, Cornell University, 2021.

Professional Services

Grant-Proposal Review Panels

National Science Foundation (NSF) review panel, IIS/RI CAREER program, 2026.

National Science Foundation (NSF) review panel, IIS/RI Future CORe program, 2026.

National Science Foundation (NSF) review panel, IIS/RI MEDIUM program, 2025.

Area Chair Roles

ICML (International Conference on Machine Learning) Area Chair, 2027.

NeurIPS (Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems) Area Chair, 2026.

ICLR (International Conference on Learning Representations) Area Chair, 2025, 2027.

ACL (Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics) Area Chair, 2023, 2025; ACL Rolling Review Area Chair, 2024; ACL Demo Track Area Chair, 2026.

EMNLP (Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing) Area Chair, 2024 **(Outstanding Area Chair Award)**, 2025; EMNLP Demo Track Area Chair, 2024.

COLING (International Conference on Computational Linguistics) Area Chair, LREC-COLING 2024 and COLING 2025.

Conference Organizing Roles

NAACL (Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics) Website Chair, 2024.

ACL Session Chair, 2024.

Tutorials and Workshops Organized

Frontiers of LLMs for Automated Scientific Discovery: A Tutorial
Organizing team: Zonglin Yang, Chandan Reddy, Xinya Du and Mengdi Wang.
In AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2026.

Hallucinations in Large Language Models and Large Vision-Language Models: A Tutorial
Organizing team: Liqiang Jing, Yue Zhang, Xinya Du.
In ACM International Conference on Multimedia Retrieval (ICMR), 2025.

AI4Research: Towards a Unified Knowledge-grounded Scientific Research Lifecycle (workshop).
Organizing team: Qingyun Wang, Wenpeng Yin, Lifu Huang, Yi R. Fung, Xinya Du, Carl Edwards, Tom Hope.
In AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2025.

Evaluations and Benchmarks in Context of Multimodal LLM (workshop).
Organizing team: Hao Fei, Xiang Yue, Kaipeng Zhang, Long Chen, Jian Li, Xinya Du.
In The IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2025.

The First Workshop on Multimodal Knowledge and Language Modeling
Organizing team: Liqiang Jing, Xinya Du, Hao Fei, Jing Gu, Manling Li, Aixin Sun, William Wang
In International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI), 2025.

Program Committee Member / Reviewer

ACL (Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics).

NeurIPS (Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems).

ICLR (International Conference on Learning Representations).

AISTATS (International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics).

EMNLP (Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing).

NAACL (Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics).

AACL/IJCNLP (Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics / International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing).

IJCAI (International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence).

AAAI (AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence).

NLPCC (Natural Language Processing and Chinese Computing).

CoNLL (Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning).

WNUT (Workshop on Noisy User-generated Text).

MRQA (Workshop on Machine Reading for Question Answering).

SEM (Joint Conference on Lexical and Computational Semantics).

Journal Reviewer

TKDE (IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering).

TASLP (IEEE Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing).

TNNLS (IEEE Transactions on Neural Networks and Learning Systems).

TALLIP (ACM Transactions on Asian and Low-Resource Language Information Processing).

TKDD (ACM Transactions on Knowledge Discovery from Data).

CL (Computational Linguistics).

KAIS (Knowledge and Information Systems).

AI Communication.

IPM (Information Processing and Management).

Ph.D./M.S. Thesis Committee Member

Ph.D.: Kangshuo Li, Souradeep Nanda, Ali Riahi, Xiangci Li, Jishnu Jaykumar Padalunkal, Basel Abdeen, Yibo Hu.

M.S.: Wooseong Yang, Shubham Patel.

Department, University, and Outreach Service

Faculty advisor and judge: Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) Symposium, UT Dallas, 2023–present.

Faculty Advisor: Women Who Compute (WWC), UT Dallas, 2024–present.

Faculty Advisor: Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers (SASE), UT Dallas, 2024–present.

Invited Speaker: UTD AI Society's "AI Chats", 2025.

Panelist: FuturED 2024 Workshop on Future of Event Detection, 2024.

Faculty Host: K-12 Outreach, UT Dallas, Summer 2023, 2024.

Research Mentor: Research, Inquiry, Design Experience (RIDE) Project, UT Dallas, 2024.

PhD Admission Committee Member, UT Dallas CS Department, 2022, 2023, 2024.

Site Host: North American Computational Linguistics Olympiad (NACLO), 2023, 2024.

PhD Admission Committee Member, Cornell CS Department, 2021.

Volunteer: Cornell CS Department PhD Visit Day, 2019, 2020, 2021.

Student Volunteer: ACL, 2017, 2018.

Student Volunteer: EMNLP, 2017.

Invited Talks and Panels

Pushing the Boundaries of LLM Agents in Data Science and Machine Learning Research.
Nvidia, Dec 2025.

Inside LLMs: Knowledge, Alignment, and Agents.
Samsung Research America (SRA), May 2025.

Towards Autonomous Scientific Discovery with Large Language Models.
UT Southwestern AI in Medicine Seminar Series, May 2025.

Synergizing Knowledge and Large Language Models.
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Data Mining Group Seminar, Oct 2024.
University of Massachusetts–Amherst, Machine Learning & Friends Lunch, Sep 2024.

Synergy between Large Language Model and Knowledge.
University of North Texas, Oct 2024.

Panelist, Future of Event Detection Workshop.
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), Nov 2024.

Faculty Round Table Talk.
UT Dallas Hobson Wildenthal Honors College, Aug 2024.

Large Language Models: Knowledge, Reasoning and Factuality.
Samsung Electronics America, Mar 2024.

Making Natural Language Reasoning Explainable and Faithful (New Faculty Highlights).
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), Feb 2024.

Open-ended Evaluations of Foundational Models: Alignment and Faithfulness.
Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Computer Science Department Seminar, Dec 2023.
Fudan University, Computer Science Department Seminar, Dec 2023.

Panelist, "ChatGPT: Fact vs. Fiction" public forum, sponsored by The Dallas Morning News.
UT Dallas, Mar 2023.

Towards More Intelligent Extraction of Information from Documents.
Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence, Mar 2022.
Facebook, Mar 2022.
Simon Fraser University, Feb 2022.
Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Feb 2022.
University of California, Merced, Feb 2022.
UIUC, Siebel School of Computing and Data Science Speaker Series, Feb 2022.

Towards More Informed Extraction of Events from Documents.
University of Chicago, Rising Stars in Data Science Workshop, Jan 2021.
Tencent AI Research America, Nov 2020.

Event Extraction by Answering (Almost) Natural Question.
UIUC, Information Extraction and Knowledge Acquisition Class, Sep 2020.

LwLL: Progress on the NLP Front.
Cornell University, DARPA site visit, Apr 2020.

Mentoring Experience

PhD students

Ruosen Li (2022–2026, UT Dallas PhD student, graduated Aug 2026).
Publications: ACL 2026; NeurIPS 2024 (two papers); TMLR 2024; EMNLP Findings 2023, 2024, 2025.

Liqiang Jing (2023–2026, UT Dallas PhD student, graduating Nov 2026).
Publications: ICLR 2025; EMNLP 2025, 2026; TMLR 2025; IJCV 2026; EMNLP Findings 2024, 2026 (two papers); ACL Findings 2025, 2026; ICMR 2025 tutorial.
Award: OpenAI Researcher Access Program.

Ruochen Li (2023–present, UT Dallas PhD student).
Publications: EMNLP 2026 (first author; an earlier version won the Best Paper Award at the AAAI 2025 AI4Research Workshop); EMNLP 2025; NeurIPS 2024; RepL4NLP Workshop at NAACL 2025.

Master Students

Milind Choudhary (2023, UT Dallas Master student) → UT Dallas PhD.
Topic: Event Extraction as Question-Answer Pairs Generation.
Publications: EACL Findings 2024.

Zimu Wang (2023–present, UT Dallas Visiting student) → UoL PhD.
Topic: Temporal relation extraction.
Publications: NeurIPS 2024, EMNLP 2025, EMNLP Findings 2024, RepL4NLP Workshop at NAACL 2025.

Son Tran (2023, UT Dallas Visiting student) → Cornell PhD.
Topic: Complex Question Answering.
Publications: NeurIPS 2024.

Chenkai Ma (2023, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: Multiple Choice Questions Reasoning.
Publications: EMNLP 2023.

Barry Wang (2021–2024, Cornell CS undergraduate student) → CMU PhD.
Topic: Automatic Error Analysis for Information Extraction.
Publications: ACL 2022, SciNLP 2022, EMNLP Findings 2023, NeurIPS 2024.

Zonglin Yang (2020–2024, Cornell CS MEng student) → NTU PhD.
Topic: Commonsense and Case-based Reasoning for NLP.
Publications: EMNLP Findings 2020, EACL 2023, EACL 2024, ACL Findings 2024 (Best Poster Award, ICML 2024 AI for Science Workshop).

Ehsan Aghazadeh (2024, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: Large Vision Language Models Interpretability.
Publications: EMNLP Findings 2026.

Bowen Yan (2024, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: Large Vision Language Models Hallucinations.
Publications: ACL Findings 2025.

Zhengsong Zhang (2024, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: Large Vision Language Models Hallucinations.
Publications: ACL Findings 2025.

Ziming Luo (2024, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: Large Language Model for Scientific Discovery.
Publications: EMNLP 2025, EMNLP Findings 2025.

Undergraduate/High School Students

Teerth Patel (UT Dallas BS student, 2023–present).
Topic: Large Language Models Peer Evaluations.
Publications: TMLR 2024.
Award: Jonsson School of Engineering and Computer Science Award.

Lei Xia (2023–2024, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: Multi-hop Question Answering.
Publications: NeurIPS 2024, EMNLP Findings 2024.

Minhao Zou (2024, UT Dallas Visiting student).
Topic: LLM for Scientific Discovery.

Arjun Junghare (2024, UT Dallas CS undergraduate student).
Topic: Image Generation with Large Language Models.

Shreya Kumara (2024, President of UTD Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers).

Anjana Bharadwaj (2024, President of UTD Women Who Compute).

Jaden Nunes (Summer 2023, DFW Local K-12 student).
Topic: Event Extraction as Question-Answer Pairs Generation.

Rishab Bhattacharya (Summer 2023, DFW Local K-12 student).
Topic: Event Extraction as Question-Answer Pairs Generation.

Shreyas Kumar (Summer 2023, DFW Local K-12 student).
Topic: Event Extraction as Question-Answer Pairs Generation.

Aliva Das (2021–2022, Cornell CS undergraduate student) → Amazon.
Topic: Automatic Error Analysis for Information Extraction.
Publications: ACL 2022, SciNLP 2021.

Rishi Malhotra (Spring 2021, Cornell CS undergraduate student) → Microsoft.
Topic: Applying Neural Document-level IE Model to the Scientific Domain.

Maitreyi Chatterjee (Spring 2021, Cornell CS undergraduate student) → LinkedIn.
Topic: Applying Neural Document-level IE Model to the Scientific Domain.

Teaching Experience

Introduction to Machine Learning, UT Dallas, Spring 2024.

Natural Language Processing, UT Dallas, Fall 2023, 2024, 2025.

Deep Learning for Natural Language Processing, UT Dallas, Spring 2023.
New course developed and taught (overall instructor score 4.75/5.0; course score 4.65/5.0). [Link]

Natural Language Processing, UT Dallas, Fall 2022.

Natural Language Processing, Cornell University, Fall 2019.
Teaching Assistant for Prof. Claire Cardie.

Natural Language Processing, Cornell University, Spring 2019.
Teaching Assistant for Prof. Yoav Artzi.

Software Engineering, Cornell University, Spring 2017, 2018.
Teaching Assistant for Prof. William Arms.

Introduction to Computing Using Python, Cornell University, Fall 2016.
Teaching Assistant for Prof. Walker White.